

SAMĀDHI WATER REPENTANCE

SCROLL TWO PRACTICE GUIDE

Afflictions, karma and ethical conduct in accessible English

four observations • body • speech • six senses

Prepared by Daniel Franjkovic

daniel.franjkovic@outlook.com.au

More Buddhist terms: www.fgsitc.org/glossary/

Open the project

Scroll Two Practice Companion

Afflictions, karma and ethical conduct in accessible English

Prepared by
Daniel Franjkovic
daniel.franjkovic@outlook.com.au

Source edition
Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple, electronic edition 3.0, 2022
English translation by Andrew Nguy and Raymond Kong
Covers Scroll Two

Further glossary
www.fgsitc.org/glossary/

This independent educational companion explains the official English liturgy without reproducing it. The source PDFs remain copyrighted by Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple and are linked in the references.

Designed for clear A4 printing. Complete collection edition, August 2026.

Contents

Part	Contents
1	Scroll Two
2	References

PDF bookmarks provide direct navigation to every major section.



Scroll Two

What each part is doing and why

Scroll Two turns the general framework of repentance into a detailed examination of afflictions, intentional action and ethical conduct. Its movement is practical: observe the mind, understand consequences, confess harmful patterns and make vows that replace them.

This guide explains the English translation without reproducing the full liturgy. Page numbers refer to Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple's 2022 electronic edition.

Before beginning

- The repeated we is the voice of a community. A practitioner does not need to claim an action they did not commit.
- The lists are intentionally comprehensive. Their purpose is to make unnoticed forms of harm visible.
- Traditional statements about karmic results express the moral cosmology of the liturgy. Karma is complex and unfolds through many conditions; the text is not offering a simple formula for judging another person's life.
- Repeated Buddha names, prostrations and vows divide the long confession into cycles of recognition, refuge and renewed direction.

Guide to Scroll Two

1. Flowers Presented Praise

Source page 3

What is happening?

The assembly bows and offers flowers to Mañjuśrī and Samantabhadra. Blossoms are imagined filling the golden hall and becoming golden lotuses.

Why is it done?

Flowers prepare the mind through beauty, generosity and impermanence. They bloom and fade, reminding practitioners that conditions change. Their transformation into lotuses expresses the possibility that ordinary, changing life can become a path of awakening.

Beginner notes

- Mañjuśrī represents wisdom that sees clearly.
- Samantabhadra represents great vows carried into action.
- A lotus grows from mud without being stained by it. It commonly symbolises awakening within the conditions of saṃsāra.
- The Universal Offering Bodhisattvas are invoked as an assembly representing offerings extended without limit.

2. Prayer of Entering Repentance

Source pages 4-8

What is happening?

The assembly formally enters the second session. It offers incense and flowers, confesses disrespect, harmful desire, anger and killing, then seeks refuge and invokes Buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Why is it done?

The entry prayer gathers body, speech and mind before the detailed confession. The ornate images establish the sanctuary as a place where ordinary habits can be examined in the presence of awakened qualities.

What does it mean?

The passage contrasts being bound by obstruction with the Buddha's freedom and compassion. Seeking the Buddha's support does not replace personal responsibility. It places reform within a relationship of refuge, teaching and encouragement.

Beginner notes

- The two obstructions are usually the obstruction of afflictions and the subtler obstruction to complete knowledge.
- Inverted views are ways of seeing that reverse Buddhist priorities, such as treating the impermanent as permanent or the unreliable as a lasting refuge.
- The thirty-two responses evoke compassionate forms adapted to the needs of beings.
- The thirty-two marks are traditional signs of a great person or Buddha.
- An asaṃkhyeya kalpa is an incalculably long period used to express the vast cultivation of Buddhahood.

3. The Four Kinds of Observation

Source pages 8-11

What is happening?

Before confessing further, the reader is asked to contemplate four subjects:

Observation	Plain meaning
Causes and conditions	Harm does not appear from nowhere. It develops through ignorance, habits, influences and choices.

Observation	Plain meaning
Results and effects	Intentional actions shape experience and future tendencies. Privilege and pleasure do not provide permanent protection.
One's own body	Awakening remains possible, but afflictions conceal that capacity.
The Tathāgata's body	The Buddha represents wisdom, compassion and freedom that are not ruled by ordinary grasping.

Why is it done?

Repentance becomes more than regret when the practitioner understands what supported the action, what it produces and what different direction is possible.

Images used in the passage

- A fish biting a hook mistakes danger for food.
- A silkworm forming a cocoon becomes trapped by what it produces.
- A moth entering a flame is destroyed by unexamined attraction.
- A person holding a boulder while sinking cannot escape while refusing to release the cause of sinking.

> In simple terms Look honestly at how harm begins, where it leads, what the mind could become and what awakening looks like.

4. Afflictions That Obstruct Practice

Source pages 11-16

What is happening?

The liturgy names afflictions that obstruct almost every level of Buddhist learning, meditation and bodhisattva practice. It moves from basic access to the Triple Gem through advanced concentrations, liberations, powers, perfections, stages and vows.

Why is the list so long?

It shows that an affliction is not only an unpleasant feeling. Greed, aversion and delusion can prevent a person from recognising teachers, hearing the Dharma, sustaining meditation, understanding emptiness or serving others effectively.

How to read the advanced lists

The passage is a map of the path, not a demand that beginners master every numbered teaching during the service.

- Breath mindfulness and counting the breath steady attention.
- Kindness, compassion, appreciative joy and equanimity are the four immeasurable attitudes.
- Foundations of mindfulness, proper exertions, faculties, powers and means to accomplishment belong to the traditional factors supporting awakening.
- Six perfections are generosity, ethics, patience, effort, meditation and wisdom.
- Four means of embracing are giving, kind speech, beneficial action and cooperation.
- Ten stages describe the progressive maturation of a bodhisattva.

What the vows add

The section does not end with self-criticism. It dedicates the confession towards freedom from compulsive rebirth, access to good teachers, mastery of helpful methods and the ability to teach beings without attachment.

5. Karmic Obstacles and the Timing of Results

Source pages 17-23

What is happening?

Having addressed afflictions, the liturgy turns to karma, the intentional actions shaped by those afflictions. It answers an old question: why can a person doing good experience difficulty, while someone acting badly appears to prosper?

The text's answer

It describes three times in which karmic results may mature:

1. In the present life
2. In the next life
3. In a later life

The point is that visible circumstances do not reveal the whole network of causes. A wholesome action is still worthwhile even when its result is not immediate.

Key ideas

- Karmic power means the capacity of intentional action to condition later experience.
- A virtuous friend or spiritual friend is someone who supports ethical and liberating practice.
- Five grave deeds, major precept offences and improper livelihoods are named as serious obstacles because they damage beings, community and trust.
- An icchantika is portrayed in some Mahāyāna texts as a person whose wholesome roots or aspiration have become extremely obstructed. The term does not need to be read as an eternal identity.

> Why this matters The section encourages persistence. Present difficulty is not proof that wholesome practice has failed, and present comfort is not proof that harmful conduct is harmless.

6. Repentance for Killing and Harm

Source pages 23-31

What is happening?

The detailed confession begins with the three physical actions, starting with killing. It includes hunting, fishing, warfare, slaughter, captivity, habitat destruction, indirect participation, careless injury and everyday actions that may harm small creatures.

Why is the scope so wide?

The precept is not limited to personally taking a human life. The text asks practitioners to notice intention, encouragement, profit, enjoyment, systems of violence and carelessness.

The kinship argument

The liturgy imagines all beings as former relatives across beginningless rebirth. This is meant to widen compassion beyond the present family or species. A being who now looks unfamiliar may once have been closely connected to us.

Traditional consequences

The text associates killing with fearful rebirths, illness and shortened life. Its practical direction is clear: protect life, reduce cruelty, cultivate compassion and help frightened beings feel safe.

The vow after confession

The positive replacement for killing is active care. The assembly vows to teach helpful Dharma, relieve fear and make its presence a condition of peace for other beings.

7. Repentance for Stealing

Source pages 32-38

What is happening?

The liturgy examines taking what has not been given. It includes robbery, coercion, corrupt government, misuse of religious property, unpaid loans, trespass, false measures, commercial deception, embezzlement and exploitation.

What does stealing mean here?

It is broader than secretly taking an object. The central question is whether another person's resources, labour, trust or common property are being taken without free and informed consent.

Why are temple goods treated seriously?

Offerings to the Buddha, Dharma and Sangha are held for communal religious purposes. Misusing them breaks both stewardship and the donors' trust.

The positive practice

The section turns greed into dānapāramitā, the perfection of generosity. Instead of asking only, "What must I not take?", it asks, "What can I freely give for the welfare and awakening of others?"

8. Repentance for Sexual Desire and Misconduct

Source pages 38-40

What is happening?

The liturgy examines sexual craving as a powerful form of attachment and confesses conduct that violates trust or ethical restraint.

What is the Buddhist concern?

The issue is not that affection or the body is inherently evil. The concern is craving that treats another person as an object, breaks commitments, causes betrayal or overwhelms clear judgement.

Monastic and lay contexts

The communal text speaks across different vows. Monastics undertake celibacy. Lay ethics commonly focus on avoiding sexual misconduct, coercion, exploitation and betrayal.

The vow after confession

The imagery of luminous, transformed birth expresses freedom from compulsive desire and the wish to meet others with purity, dignity and wisdom.

9. The Four Unwholesome Verbal Actions

Source pages 41-46

What is happening?

The assembly confesses four harmful uses of speech:

Verbal action	Plain meaning
False speech	Deliberately misleading others.
Divisive speech	Setting people or groups against one another.

Verbal action	Plain meaning
Harsh speech	Using words to wound, humiliate or inflame hatred.
Idle or irresponsible speech	Speech that wastes attention, distorts values or encourages heedlessness.

The source moves between these categories rather than presenting them as a modern checklist.

Why can speech be karmically powerful?

Words organise relationships and communities. A sentence can preserve trust, incite violence, spread false teaching or reconcile a conflict. Speech is therefore an intentional action, not merely sound.

Claims of spiritual attainment

The text treats falsely claiming meditation or awakening as especially serious. Such claims exploit faith and misrepresent the path.

The positive replacement

The vows seek truthful, harmonious, beneficial and timely speech, together with the confidence and skill to teach without deception.

10. Repentance Through the Six Sense Faculties

Source pages 47-49

What is happening?

The confession reviews how the eye, ear, nose, tongue, body and mind become caught by attractive or repulsive objects.

Faculty	Object	Common reaction
Eye	Forms and colour	Attraction, comparison, judgement
Ear	Sounds	Chasing praise or resisting criticism
Nose	Scents	Desire or aversion
Tongue	Tastes	Craving and excess
Body	Touch	Comfort-seeking and resistance
Mind	Thoughts and ideas	Grasping views, memories and fantasies

Why is mind a sense?

In Buddhist analysis, thoughts and mental images are objects known by mental consciousness, just as visible forms are known by visual consciousness. Mind is not presented as a permanent soul.

The transformation

The vows do not ask practitioners to destroy the senses. They ask that seeing, hearing and thinking become clear, compassionate and free from automatic grasping.

The six senses

faculty + object + consciousness = contact

Faculty	Object	Consciousness
Eye	forms and colours	visual consciousness
Ear	sounds	auditory consciousness
Nose	odours	olfactory consciousness
Tongue	tastes	taste consciousness
Body	touch, pressure, temperature	tactile consciousness
Mind	thoughts, memories, images and other mental objects	mental consciousness

Together the six faculties, six objects and six consciousnesses are called the eighteen realms.

11. Seven Buddhas Offence-Extinguishing Mantra

Source page 50

What is happening?

A short mantra marks the completion of Scroll Two's main confession.

How should a beginner approach it?

The English heading names the chant, but the line beneath it is a transliteration, not an English sentence. Its sounds began in an Indic language, were represented phonetically with Chinese characters, and were transmitted through Chinese Buddhist chanting. Some Sanskrit elements remain recognisable, while other syllables cannot be translated securely.

Its ritual function is concentration, continuity with transmitted practice and the sealing of the confession.

Use the temple text and follow the officiant's rhythm. English phonetic spellings cannot fully reproduce the source sounds.

Sound, meaning and purpose

Where: source PDF page 50, printed page 48.

> Source form: ripa ripate kuha kuhate tranite nigalate
> vimarite mahāgate jāmlamcamte svāhā
> Easy cue: REE-pah REE-pah-tay, KOO-hah KOO-hah-tay, TRAH-nee-tay, NEE-gah-lah-tay;
> VEE-mah-ree-tay, mah-HAA-gah-tay, JAHM-lahm-CHAHM-tay, SWAA-hah.

What it means: There is no responsible word-for-word translation of the whole formula. Mahā means “great”, gate is related to going or having gone, and svāhā is a traditional ending that seals or completes a mantra. Its Chinese title gives the reliable overall meaning: a mantra of the Seven Buddhas for extinguishing offences.

Why it is chanted: It gathers attention, expresses the intention that harmful karma and its obstructions be purified, and seals Scroll Two's confession of conduct before the exit prayer. In simple terms, the practitioner is acknowledging harm, asking that its obstructive force be cleared, and committing to move towards awakening.

12. Prayer of Exiting Repentance

Source pages 51-52

What is happening?

The assembly formally leaves the second session. It acknowledges the practice completed, dedicates its merit and vows to become a support for the Buddhadharma and for living beings.

Why is an exit prayer needed?

A ritual ending gathers the mind after an intense confession. It prevents the practice from stopping at remorse and directs its energy towards wisdom, service and continued cultivation.

Beginner notes

- The other shore is liberation from the compulsive cycle of suffering.
- Pāramitā means a perfection or practice carried to liberating completeness.
- To become the pillars and crossbeams of the Buddhadharma means to help sustain the teaching and community.

13. Verse of Dedication

Source page 53

What is happening?

The merit of the session is shared universally. The verse joins kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity with gratitude, ethical practice, Chan and Pure Land aspirations.

Why does Scroll Two end this way?

Dedication prevents the practice from being treated as private moral self-improvement. Whatever clarity or goodness has arisen is directed towards families, communities and all beings.

Scroll Two in one view

Movement	Purpose
Offering and entry	Establish reverence and collected attention.
Four observations	Understand causes, effects, present capacity and awakening.
Affliction confession	Identify what blocks learning and practice.
Karmic confession	Examine intentional action and its consequences.
Body, speech and senses	Apply the teaching to ordinary conduct.
Mantra, exit and dedication	Seal the practice and direct its benefit outwards.

Scroll Two's central lesson is that repentance must reach behaviour. Insight into affliction becomes credible when killing is replaced with protection, stealing with generosity, misconduct with respect, harmful speech with truthful care and sensory grasping with mindful awareness.



References

Sources and editorial limits

Links were checked on 24 August 2026. The guide paraphrases its copyrighted source and uses short labels only where necessary for explanation.

Source liturgy

- Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple. Liturgy of the Samādhi Water Repentance of Kindness and Compassion: Scroll One. Electronic edition 3.0, 2022. Main source for the Scroll One guide and page map.
- Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple. Scroll Two. Electronic edition 3.0, 2022. Main source for the Scroll Two guide and page map.
- Fo Guang Shan Hsi Lai Temple. Scroll Three. Electronic edition 3.0, 2022. Main source for the Scroll Three guide, memorial rites and final prayer.

The PDFs credit Andrew Nguy and Raymond Kong as translators, editors and graphic designers. They state that reproduction requires the publisher's permission except for fair use. The original PDFs are therefore not included in this repository.

Fo Guang Shan and Hsi Lai Temple resources

- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. Buddhist Glossary. Primary terminology cross-check.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. The Heart Sūtra. Five aggregates, emptiness and Avalokiteśvara.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. The Amitabha Sutra. Amitābha, Sukhāvatī and Pure Land practice.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. The Forty-Eight Vows of Amitabha Buddha. Dharmākara's vows and Pure Land aspiration.

- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. Starting a Daily Practice. Amitābha name-recitation, Pure Land aspiration and the image of rebirth on a lotus.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. Master's Advice on Daily Practice. Refuge, prostration, offerings, chanting and dedication.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. Visiting a Buddhist Temple. Temple etiquette and ritual actions.
- Fo Guang Shan International Translation Center. The Buddhist Perspective on Life and Destiny. Karma, repentance and the image of Dharma water.
- Fo Guang Shan. Samantabhadra Bodhisattva Shrine. White elephant, six tusks, vows and practice.
- Fo Guang Shan. Objectives of Fo Guang Shan. Humanistic Buddhist institutional context.

Canonical and translation sources

- BDK America. The Mahayana Sutra of Previous Lives and Contemplation of the Mind-ground. Confession, shame, vows and repentance at phenomenal and principle levels.
- BDK America. A Forest of Pearls from the Dharma Garden, volume 1. Traditional cosmology and six-realm context.
- 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha. The Dhāraṇī “Essence of Immeasurable Longevity and Wisdom”. A canonical example linking recitation of Amitābha's name with Sukhāvatī and lotus birth rather than gestation in a womb.
- SuttaCentral. Aṅguttara Nikāya 6.63, Penetrative. Early Buddhist definition of karma through intention.
- SuttaCentral. Saṃyutta Nikāya 12.2, Analysis of Dependent Origination. The twelve links.

Later Pure Land teaching used with a clear label

- Amitabha Buddhist Society. Pure Mind, Compassionate Heart: Lessons from the Amitabha Sutra, p. 91. Source for the later devotional image of a lotus associated with the practitioner and described as bearing the practitioner's name. The companion does not present this detail as wording from the Water Repentance or the shorter Amitābha Sūtra.

Historical and academic studies

- De Hong. A Study and Translation of The Compassionate Water Repentance Ritual. University of the West, 2011. Main historical study used for the development of the ritual, uncertain authorship, traditional Wuda narrative, and phenomenal and principle repentance.
- Wendi L. Adamek. “Addressing the Mind: Developments in the Culture of Confession in Sui-Tang China”. Journal of Chinese Buddhist Studies 28, 2015, pp. 117-152. Chinese Buddhist confession and repentance context.
- Sun He-Rong. “A Study on the Purification of Defilements in The Compassion-Samadhi-Water-Repentance”. Nanhua University, 2024. Modern study of the first scroll's defilement lists and practice.
- Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy. Japanese Pure Land Philosophy. Used cautiously for the broader doctrinal distinction between Pure Land aspiration and ordinary saṃsāric heaven. The companion does not treat the Chinese liturgy as a Japanese sectarian text.

Artwork records

Each image caption in FIGURES.md gives its direct museum or Wikimedia source and licence. Key collection records include:

- The Metropolitan Museum of Art: Avalokiteśvara, Samantabhadra, Mahāsthāmaprāpta and Ksitigarbha.
- Wikimedia Commons: Śākyamuni, Vairocana, Amitābha, Dīpaṃkara, Maitreya, Medicine Master Buddha, Prabhūtaratna and Śākyamuni and the Seven Buddhas.

Editorial limits

- Sanskrit names and terms are normalised only where the identification is secure. The source spelling remains the reference for chanting.
- English pronunciation cues are approximations, not International Phonetic Alphabet transcriptions. In communal chanting, the officiant and the source's pinyin rhythm take priority.
- Mantra words are translated only where the Sanskrit sense is reasonably secure. Transmitted syllables with uncertain grammar are explained by ritual function rather than assigned an invented literal meaning.
- Lotus birth is distinguished from the later devotional image of a name-bearing lotus. The former is widely attested in Pure Land sources; the latter is presented as a teaching image, not as a sentence from the source liturgy.
- Vietnamese names are a recognition aid only. Tone and regional pronunciation should be learned from a Vietnamese speaker or temple.
- Literal and psychological interpretations of cosmological realms are both identified as recognised approaches. The guide does not claim that all Buddhist traditions interpret them in the same way.
- The traditional Wuda narrative is explained respectfully and distinguished from historical verification.

May the benefit of this work support understanding, compassionate reform and the awakening of all beings.

For further Buddhist terminology

www.fgsitc.org/glossary/